DAN JOHNSTON

phone: 312.927.1247
email: drj8022@gmail.com
url: https://danjohnston.com/
address: 35 Allston Street
Boston MA 02124

Seeking a creative technical position where my passion and experience can contribute towards building simple, successful, and memorable user experiences.

ABOUT

TBWA\CHIAT\DAY NY — Boston, MA
Associate Director of Technology — *Aug 2022 - Oct 2026*

I currently work with a diverse team of a dozen-odd creative professionals who are focused on building best in class web experiences. Some projects are content heavy—spanning thousands of pages, while others might feature robust data-driven tooling, or custom 3rd party integrations. Depending on the complexity of the ask, timelines range from just a few weeks to the better part of a year.

I have been fortunate to see many successful site launches, which has given me a good sense of how other teams define success and how to best assist them. I work with producers to keep projects on schedule. Providing time estimates and calling out roadblocks well ahead of time. During internal design reviews I can suggest alternatives that address the problem, but with a shorter build time. I'll talk extensively with QA, analytics, strategy, and content teams to ensure the final product matches expectations.

I often lead the technology decisions for the front-end portion of our development work. Typically this includes initial setup and configuration of an open source CMS paired with a React-based framework. Then I'll create a repo and do some basic AWS config. Next I'll set up data models to capture all necessary content, and rough in a "skeleton" of how the various components should fit together. The result should be easy enough for a new developer to pick up quickly, yet complex enough to handle edge cases arising from design and business requirements.

At the end of the day, I like to build cool stuff with great people. I like solving problems I don't already know the answer to. I like being surprised by what I find. I'm comfortable with ambiguity. I like advocating for others. I also have a security clearance, which is kinda neat.

MullenLowe / Lead developer	Feb 2020 - Aug 2022
MullenLowe / Senior developer	Sep 2019 - Feb 2020
MullenLowe / Developer	Apr 2017 - Sep 2019
Mullen / Creative technologist	June 2015 - Apr 2017

Lorem ipsum

EXPERIENCE

Curiosity.com — Chicago, IL
Front End Developer & UX Designer — *May 2014 - June 2015*
Working in a fast paced startup environment on an experimental educational video platform. My team was tasked with creating a unified look and feel from tens of thousands of videos pulled from multiple sources with uneven metadata. During daily stands we decided which KPIs to focus on; based on new API features implemented by the backend team and robust analytics user data. Day to day, I would create detailed wireframes, get them approved by management, implement the feature, and submit code for review.

Digital Kitchen / Front end developer — Chicago, IL / Aug 2012 - May 2014

MediumBold / Front end developer — Boston, MA / Jun 2010 - Jun 2012

MIT Mobile Experience Lab — Cambridge, MA
Web & Interactive Designer — *Oct 2008 - May 2010*
Starting in a part-time position while in grad school, I transitioned to full-time upon completing my degree. This academic design research lab explored the boundaries of HCI at the time. My role was to support the PI and engineers. I created wireframes, shot videos, built wordpress sites, designed books, posters, and any other collateral as required. Participating in brainstorming and whiteboarding sessions with some of the brightest minds (and biggest personalities) on earth remains a career highlight.

Commonwealth of Massachusetts (ITD) / Developer — Boston, MA / Aug 2005 - Aug 2007

VPG Integrated Media / Flash developer & Production artist — Boston, MA / Jan 2002 - Jul 2005

TOOLS

VS Code, SourceTree, Git, Node, JavaScript, PHP, GraphQL, REST, Xcode, Bash, AWS Amplify, AWS Elastic Beanstalk, AWS EC2, React, Next, Radix, Strapi, Adobe Experience Manager, Figma, Photoshop, OpenAi, VLC, Jira, WCAG/508, l10n

CLIENTS

Century 21, The City of Venice. Corona, Department of Defense, Harvard Business School, HBO, Hyatt, JetBlue, JFK Library & Museum, MIT Media Lab, Monster.com, National Geographic, Royal Carribean, Sierra Nevada

EDUCATION

MFA - Dynamic Media
Massachusetts College of Art and Design, May 2009

BFA - Industrial Design
Rochester Institute of Technology, June 2001

INTERESTS

Cycling, Español, Music, Travel, Journalism, Woodworking, Architecture

RECOMMENDATIONS

Dave Lee
VP Head of Digital - TBWA\Chiat\Day\NY

I have had the honor of getting to work with and manage Dan over the past 11+ years at TBWA (formerly MullenLowe) and in that time I have been constantly impressed at every turn by his technical skills and ability to learn and adapt to new challenges and new coding languages from project to project.

Dan has led countless projects over the years and every project has brought new challenges and obstacles. He is unmatched in his ability to switch gears between completely different frameworks and tech stacks and manage multiple work streams in-tandem. One great example was when he was leading the buildout of an AEM frontend design system while also running support on a React-based project at the same time. He was the driving factor in making sure the AEM site matched the approved designs while still being as customizable as possible by CMS users. His learnings from that also helped shape the way we would plan and deliver future projects in more customizable frameworks and platforms (such as Strapi/React/NextJS).

When it comes to emerging technology, Dan is constantly looking for the next big platform or framework, not just to know what's out there, but to learn and master it. He was instrumental in driving headless architecture concepts for several clients over the past six years and has been able to bring cutting edge ideas to every project.

Dan has also been a great collaborator across different teams, and has been able to hone his ability to explain technical problems in a clear and concise way for non-technical people. He is a constant partner to UX and Design team members which has helped ensure that Design System concepts come to life in an easily scalable way on every project.

Dan is one of the best people I've ever had the joy of working with, and any organization would be lucky to have such a smart, driven, and collaborative person on their team!